

Joshua P. Thompson

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

August 2022 – May 2026

Concentration: Cybersecurity and Forensics

Kent State University – Kent, OH

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.89/4.00
- **Honors & Awards:** Dean's List every semester & President's List two semesters

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCES

Student Research Contributor (Community Engagement Project)

January 2025 – April 2025

Zooniverse.org — *Academic / Research Experience*

Project

- Contributed to public research initiatives by completing 300+ verified data classifications, supporting large-scale academic datasets.
- Applied critical thinking, pattern recognition, and data validation to ensure accuracy and consistency across submissions.
- Worked independently in a remote research environment, demonstrating self-management and accountability.
- Strengthened attention to detail and documentation skills relevant to digital forensics and data integrity.

Python Programming Case Study (CSV Data Management Application)

February 2025 – March 2025

Kent State University — *Academic Project*

Project

- Designed and implemented a Python application to read, update, and persist structured data stored in CSV files.
- Used Python, file I/O, conditional logic, and loops to manage dynamic user input and multiple execution paths.
- Applied pseudocode and flowchart planning to reduce runtime errors and improve program clarity.
- Conducted repeated testing with varied inputs to ensure error-free execution and reliable output.

Cybersecurity Lab Exercises (Incident Response & Vulnerability Analysis)

Fall 2024 – Present

Kent State University — *Academic / Lab Experience*

Research

- Researched and analyzed Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures (CVEs) to assess severity and organizational risk.
- Used PowerShell, Linux command-line tools, and system logs to identify potential security issues.
- Configured and evaluated basic security controls, including network interface resets and rogue DHCP detection.
- Gained hands-on exposure to incident response workflows, emphasizing documentation and ethical decision-making.

Web Honeypot Configuration Lab

Fall 2024

Kent State University — *Academic Lab Experience*

Project

- Deployed a basic web honeypot using Pentbox to simulate a vulnerable service environment.
- Observed and analyzed interaction attempts to understand common **attack patterns and reconnaissance behavior**.
- Strengthened understanding of **defensive security concepts** and attacker methodologies.

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ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCES

Twinsburg Warehouse Bargains

2018 – 2023

Director of Operations

- Implemented a digital inventory management system and achieved a successful deployment of a real-time inventory tracking platform to monitor warehouse stock.
- Developed and launched our website to achieve strategic web presence that increased in-store foot traffic and digital outreach.
- Oversaw multiple employees to ensure customer satisfaction was being met and that procedures and guidelines were being followed in the warehouse
- Responsible for the categorization and inventory product quality inspection for all incoming and outgoing shipment orders

Sears, Roebuck and Co

2007 – 2015

Small Engine Mechanic / Test Service Technician

- Advanced rapidly from entry-level technician to Test Service Technician with an assistant, reflecting strong performance and trust.
- Diagnosed and repaired complex mechanical systems, reinforcing systematic troubleshooting and root-cause analysis.
- Balanced quality control, safety, and efficiency in a fast-paced service environment.
- Developed strong technical documentation and customer communication skills transferable to IT and cybersecurity roles.